

KADEN SCHMIDT

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EDUCATION

Iowa State University, College of Engineering

Ames, IA.

Bachelor of Science in Aerospace Engineering

Expected May 2027

Relevant Coursework: Aerospace Structures, Aerodynamics, Flight Dynamics, Astrodynamics, Mechanics of Materials.

GPA: 3.4

EXPERIENCE

HABET (HIGH ALTITUDE BALLOONS & EMERGING TECHNOLOGIES)

Ames, IA

Make To Innovate Program

August 2025 – Present

- Collaborate on aerospace system design, payload integration, and flight mission operations for high-altitude balloon research.
- Integrate payload systems, create unique GPS tracking systems, and other components to track atmospheric data.
- Conduct pre-launch testing and data analysis to ensure safe flight conditions and improve mission reliability.
- Attend weekly meetings to coordinate tasks and maintain project alignment.
- Develop mission documentation and technical memos to support design reviews and continuous improvement.

UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCH ASSISTANT - FLIGHT CONTROL SYSTEMS

Ames, IA

Research Assistant

Jan 2025 – May 2025

- Collaborated with faculty and peers on drone flight control research.
- Conducted simulations and data analysis using MATLAB and Python to evaluate control algorithms.
- Analyzed flight data to assess model accuracy and refine controller performance.
- Contributed to technical report preparation and presented findings to faculty and graduate researchers and professors.

UNITED STATES SENATE

Washington, D.C.

Senatorial Intern

May 2025 – August 2025

- Worked in the office of Senate Majority Leader John Thune
- Authored 8–10 weekly policy briefings and legislative summaries for senior officials.
- Managed constituent communications, drafting 100+ policy-related responses daily and logging over 200 messages.
- Developed strategic communication plans in collaboration with cross-functional teams.
- Engaged with government officials, industry representatives, and advocacy groups to advance legislative initiatives especially in the fields of science and technology.

SKILLS/ACTIVITIES

Technical Proficiencies: Python, MATLAB, C, LaTeX, GitHub, SolidWorks, Ansys, Microsoft Office Suite.

Research & Analysis: Flight control system simulation and data analysis, High-altitude balloon testing and mission control, Technical report preparation, Policy research and legislative briefings.

Language Skills: English (Native), Spanish (Intermediate).

Activities:

Chess: 2012 - Present

- Achieved a peak rating above 2100, ranking in the top 0.1% of players worldwide.
- Former high school Chess Club President and school chess champion.
- Currently the #1 rated player at Iowa State University.
- Won first prize at several local tournaments.

Men's Club Basketball Team – Health and Safety Officer: January 2024 – Present

- Organize practices, tournaments, and travel logistics; led team to regional tournament appearance.
- Mentor new members and help promote teamwork and safety within the club.

Football - Team Captain, All-State & All-Conference: August 2019 - November 2022

- High School varsity team captain, developing leadership and discipline through competitive athletics.
- Academic All-State recipient.

NATIONAL RECOGNITION AND AWARDS

- **Congress-Bundestag Youth Exchange (CBYX) Scholar** – Selected as 1 of 65 U.S. young professionals for a fully funded, year-long fellowship in Germany focused on professional development and cross-cultural exchange.
- **Senate Tribute, Sen. John Thune** – Recognized by the U.S. Senate for contributions and service in congress.
- **Master Builders of Iowa Scholarship**- Selected as a finalist for the competitive Master Builders of Iowa Scholarship, recognizing excellence in engineering and interest in the construction industry.